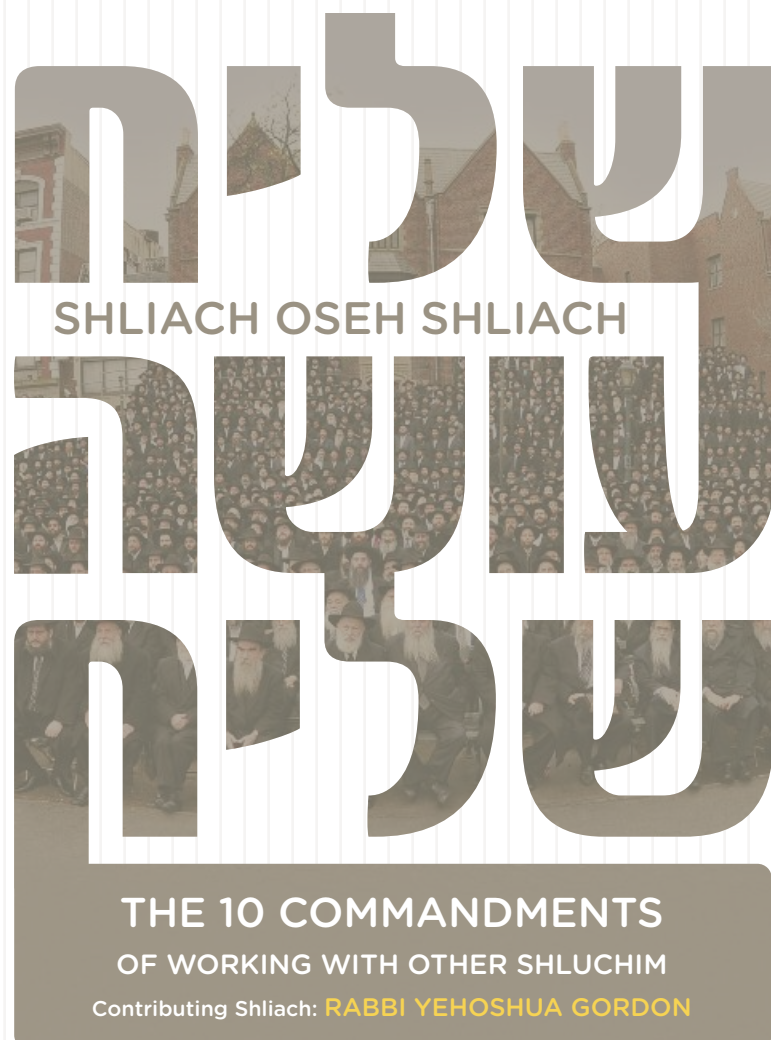




While the inyan of shlichus is not a recent concept, the inyan of shliach *oseh* shliach—empowering shluchim to hire and make new shluchim and give them the same chashivus and powers in their communities and neighboring communities — is very much an innovation of the Rebbe.

This ground-breaking idea has allowed the family of shluchim to expand exponentially over the past years. Along with it, though, comes all sorts of issues.

In my experience, I’ve learned a few tidbits of wisdom and have created three sets of “Ten Commandments for

Shluchim” - pointers that can help increase one’s success in shlichus.

The first and second sets of commandments were published in previous issues. The third and final set, which we present here, is applicable to “employee shluchim”.

SET 3

TEN COMMANDMENTS FOR THE EMPLOYEE SHLIACH

- 1 **ALWAYS REMEMBER THAT YOU WORK FOR THE REBBE, BUT THE FLOW COMES TO YOU VIA YOUR EMPLOYER SHLIACH.** I was brought to The Valley by Rabbi Cunin, and very often when we wanted to bring new shluchim or start new programs, the Rebbe wrote, “with the agreement of Rabbi Cunin.” Yes, you are the Rebbe’s shliach, but work with your head shliach.
- 2 **EVERYONE HAS TO REPORT TO SOMEONE.** You report to your employer shliach. Don’t take it personally—it’s the way of the world.
- 3 **ESTABLISH OPEN, RESPECTFUL COMMUNICATION WITH YOUR EMPLOYER SHLIACH.** When there’s a breakdown in communication, there’s almost always a breakdown in relationship. Respectfully share your dreams, your frustrations, etc. Communicate and be honest about how you feel. If something’s a deal-breaker and you say so respectfully, you’re doing a mitzva. If you tell that to everyone but your employer, that is *loshon hara*.
- 4 **TRY TO BE IRREPLACEABLE IN THE EYES OF YOUR EMPLOYER.** Do a phenomenal job. Have your employer shliach get a headache even thinking about what would happen if you left! Irreplaceable employees almost never get fired. Be respectful to your employer shliach and always be ready to go the extra mile.
- 5 **DON’T EXPECT YOUR BOSS TO PROVIDE FOR ALL OF YOUR NEEDS.** To feel that your employer must give you everything isn’t realistic and will eventually break up a relationship.
- 6 **DON’T EXPECT SOMEONE ELSE TO RAISE THE MONEY TO SUPPORT YOUR LIFESTYLE—GO RAISE IT YOURSELF, AND BECOME A SUCCESS ON YOUR OWN!** Be a capitalist. Take responsibility for yourself and your family. Your employer is not your god. No one owns you, and no one owes you.
- 7 **YOUR EMPLOYER NEEDS TO GIVE YOU THE OPPORTUNITY TO EARN MORE MONEY THAN YOU DO THROUGH HIM.** Then, it’s your responsibility to do the work necessary to earn it.
- 8 **ALWAYS LOOK AT PEOPLE WITH MORE DIFFICULT BOSSES THAN YOU, AND TRY TO APPRECIATE THE GOOD QUALITIES OF YOUR EMPLOYER.** Look at the positive. Address small problems or issues before they become big ones.
- 9 **BE A CONSCIENTIOUS EMPLOYEE.** According to halacha, a worker picking fruit off the top of a tree may recite shema on top of the tree rather than come down and waste his employer’s time. You have a responsibility to your employer. Being an employee is a serious Torah commitment.
- 10 **IF AT ALL APPROPRIATE, TRY TO GET YOUR OWN SHLICHUS BEFORE ACCEPTING A JOB FOR ANOTHER SHLIACH.** If you do work for someone else, ask yourself: Why haven’t I gotten my own shlichus? When you have that answer, it will be easier to deal with the idiosyncrasies of the guy you work for.

If you take these seriously, I promise you’ll find tremendous improvement in your lives. And if I can help even one shliach improve his employer-employee relationship, hopefully other shluchim will follow. ☞